

PORTAL QA · ROUND 5

Templates page audit

May 13, 2026

Round 5 verification of the Templates page. The dev marked the page "done" after round 4. Live check confirms **7 of 9 round-4 findings fully shipped**: the eyebrow active/archived split, the Archived collapsible section, the category-chip migration, the kind-field free-text inline-edit, the phase-subtitle migration, the brief-field defaults, and the template-tile icon styling all match the original now. USE TEMPLATE button is also gone, modal on **+ New template** is gone. Strong round.

5 findings still open. Two are partial fixes from round 4; three are fresh observations from the verification sweep:

- **FROM PREVIOUS QA** — RESET TO DEFAULT renders on Brand Refresh + Content but is missing on Account Management. The conditional gate has a hole.
- **FROM PREVIOUS QA** — **+ New template** creates the entry inline (correct) but doesn't auto-select + focus the name field for instant rename. User has to click the new entry, then click the name to start editing.
- **NEW** — **+ Add phase** creates the new phase row but doesn't put it into edit mode. Typing immediately after the click does nothing; the user has to discover that double-click activates the rename input. Original auto-focuses + pre-selects the default text on create so the first keystroke replaces it.
- **NEW** — PHASES subtitle on Custom templates stays at the static line *"Phases will appear as cards on the board."* even after a phase is added. Original switches to an italic editable prompt *"Describe how this template's phases are paced"* once phases exist — the prompt teaches the author the slot is editable. Discoverability gap on the portal.
- **NEW** — Custom (user-created) templates render extra header chrome the original

hides: an "Add a description..." placeholder and the ↓ *Click any field to edit* pill both appear on fresh Custom templates even though they're not useful there. The original gates both on whether the template is built-in.

5 findings · 0 HIGH · 1 MED · 4 LOW · 0 INFO

Status legend: **HIGH** blocks scanning / breaks workflow · **MED** meaningful divergence · **LOW** polish · **INFO** matches or working as intended.

Each finding carries two chips. **Severity** (HIGH / MED / LOW / INFO) maps to impact. **History tag** (**FROM PREVIOUS QA** = carried over from prior QA, **NEW** = surfaced this round) shows which items the dev has been sitting on vs. fresh observations. **FROM PREVIOUS QA** items need triage first.

New this round

LOW

NEW

PHASES subtitle on Custom templates stays static after a phase is added; original switches to an editable prompt

Where to see: Top → Templates → click **+ New template** → click the new entry → click **+ Add phase**. Look at the PHASES section subtitle next to the eyebrow.

Portal: Subtitle stays at the static text *"Phases will appear as cards on the board."* regardless of whether the template has 0 or N phases. The line reads as a fixed description of behavior; nothing tells the user the subtitle slot is editable.

Original: Subtitle text switches based on phase count:

- **0 phases:** *"Phases will appear as cards on the board."* (matches portal — explaining behavior to a brand-new template)
- **1+ phases:** *"Describe how this template's phases are paced"* (italic, lighter colour, clickable). The subtitle becomes an editable prompt teaching the author that the slot is theirs to fill — click, type a real pacing description, hit Enter to commit. Built-in templates skip the prompt and render their migrated custom copy directly (e.g. *"One-time engagement, roughly 8-12 weeks"* on Brand Refresh) — that's what shipped in round 5.

Fix: Mirror the original's state machine on the PHASES subtitle:

- **Custom + 0 phases** → render static factual line.
- **Custom + 1+ phases** → render italic editable prompt (light text colour, clickable, opens the inline-edit input on click; same component the kind chip uses now after the round-5 fix landed there).
- **Built-in** → render the template's migrated custom subtitle (already shipped in round 5).

Without the editable-prompt state, the user has no signal that the subtitle is theirs to author. Discoverability gap — they may never realize they can pace their own Custom templates.

MED

NEW

"**+ Add phase**" creates the new phase but doesn't put it into edit mode for inline rename

Where to see: Top → Templates → click any template → click **+ Add phase** at the bottom of the phases list. Watch what happens after the click and try to immediately type a name.

Portal: Clicking **+ Add phase** creates a new row at the bottom of the phases list reading *"New phase"*. The row is highlighted, but the text node remains a read-only span — the inline text input isn't focused. Typing immediately after the click does nothing. The user has to discover that a double-click (or some other gesture) activates edit mode. Nikko tried single-click + type and the rename didn't go through.

Original: Same **+ Add phase** click creates the same *"New phase"* row, but on the original the inline text input is focused immediately + the default text is pre-selected. The user can start typing the real phase name right away; the first keystroke replaces "New phase" with the user's input. Enter commits, Escape cancels. Same instant-edit pattern Notes uses for **+ New note** and the inline-rename uses on the Client hero.

Fix: After creating the new phase row, the click handler needs to do two more things — same fix shape as the **+ New template** finding below:

- **Mount the inline text input** in edit mode (not the read-only span) so the first keystroke goes somewhere useful.
- **Focus the input + select the default "New phase" text** so typing replaces it rather than appending. Use `autoFocus + ref.current?.select()` on the input ref, same pattern the Client hero's inline rename uses. Wire Enter to commit + Escape to cancel for keyboard parity.

Strong UX win because phase authoring is a frequent action — every new template requires 5-12 phases. "Click, click, click, select-all, type" becomes "click, type" with this fix.

LOW

NEW

Custom (user-created) template header renders extra chrome the original hides

Where to see: Top → Templates → click + **New template** to create a blank entry → click the new entry in the list to open it → look at the right-pane header.

Portal: A fresh Custom template renders the header as: *Title* + "*Add a description...*" placeholder + *Custom* chip + ↓ *Click any field to edit* pill + **ARCHIVE**. Five elements on a header that has nothing in it yet.

Original: Same fresh-Custom state renders the header as: *Title* + *Custom* chip + **ARCHIVE**. Three elements. The description-placeholder slot and the click-to-edit pill BOTH hide on Custom templates because the user just created the template from scratch — they already know it's empty and they're about to fill it in. The pill is a discovery aid for built-in templates with populated fields that look static but are actually editable. On an empty Custom template it's dead weight.

Fix: Gate both elements on whether the template is built-in OR has any content yet:

- **Click-to-edit pill** — render only when the template is built-in (workspace-seeded). Custom templates skip it; their fields are obviously empty, no discovery aid needed.
 - **Description placeholder** — render the slot only when the template has a description set. For empty descriptions on Custom templates, omit the slot entirely (the click target for adding one can live elsewhere, or appear on hover).
- Same render-gate pattern would tidy any future chrome that's only relevant when the template is built-in or populated.

Still open from round 4

LOW

FROM PREVIOUS QA

RESET TO DEFAULT shipped on Brand Refresh + Content but still missing on Account Management

Where to see: Top → Templates → click any built-in template → detail header → look for the **RESET TO DEFAULT** button between the kind chip and ARCHIVE.

Portal: Fixed where rendered: Brand Refresh, Content — 8 articles/mo, and the other built-ins tested all render RESET TO DEFAULT in the right slot, immediately before ARCHIVE. The button is wired correctly on those templates.

Still broken on Account Management: the header shows only the kind chip + Click-to-edit pill + ARCHIVE. No RESET TO DEFAULT. Same partial state from round 4 — the dev addressed most built-ins but Account Management didn't make the list.

Original: Every built-in template renders RESET TO DEFAULT without exception. User-created (Custom) templates correctly hide the button — verified by inspecting the empty New template entries on the portal, which also correctly omit it. The render gate is what differs: portal's gate misses Account Management even though it's a built-in.

Fix: Locate the conditional that decides whether to render RESET TO DEFAULT in the template-header component. Confirm the workspace-seeded template IDs all match the gate's allowlist. Account Management is being treated as Custom or its ID isn't in the built-in set. Once fixed there, sanity-check every other built-in (Copywriting / Content, Creative / Design, Email Marketing, Finance / Billing, Hosting / IT, and the rest of the 25 active list) to make sure none have the same gap.

LOW

FROM PREVIOUS QA

"**+ New template**" no longer opens a modal, but the new entry doesn't auto-select + focus the name

Where to see: Top → Templates → click **+ New template** in the top-right of the left rail. Watch what happens immediately after the click.

Portal: Fixed: the modal is gone. Clicking the button immediately creates a blank "New template" entry in the list with a *Custom* chip. Eyebrow count bumps from 25 *ACTIVE* to 26 *ACTIVE* in real time. The Name + Kind required-field gate is gone (correct).

Still incomplete: the new entry is created but NOT selected. The right pane stays blank (whatever was last open clears out). The user has to manually click the new entry to enter the editor, then click the name to rename. Two extra clicks for what should be instant. Side effect of testing this: three empty "New template" entries piled up at the top of the list because each click creates a new one without committing focus.

Original: Click **+ New template** → entry appears + gets selected + the name field gets focused with the default "New template" text pre-selected, ready for the user to type a real name and hit Enter. Same instant-edit pattern Notes uses for "+ New note." Three single-keystroke interactions become one click.

Fix: After creating the new template, the click handler needs to do two more things:

- **Select the new entry** so the right pane mounts the editor against it (same selection state any template-row click would trigger).
- **Focus the name field in the header with the default text selected** so the user can start typing a real name immediately. Use *autoFocus* + *select()* on the input ref, same pattern the inline-rename uses on the Client hero.

Build checklist

Every actionable finding (HIGH / MED / LOW). INFO items are listed in the body but not in the checklist. Tick each as it ships.

- ☐ **LOW** **PHASES subtitle on Custom templates stays static after a phase is added; original switches to an editable prompt**
Mirror the original's state machine on the PHASES subtitle:
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 - **Focus the input + select the default "New phase" text** so typing replaces it rather than appending. Use `autoFocus + ref.current?.select()` on the input ref, same pattern the Client hero's inline rename uses. Wire Enter to commit + Escape to cancel for keyboard parity.Strong UX win because phase authoring is a frequent action — every new template requires 5-12 phases. "Click, click, click, select-all, type" becomes "click, type" with this fix.
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Gate both elements on whether the template is built-in OR has any content yet:
 - **Click-to-edit pill** — render only when the template is built-in (workspace-seeded). Custom templates skip it; their fields are obviously empty, no discovery aid needed.
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RESET TO DEFAULT shipped on Brand Refresh + Content but still missing on Account Management

Locate the conditional that decides whether to render RESET TO DEFAULT in the template-header component. Confirm the workspace-seeded template IDs all match the gate's allowlist. Account Management is being treated as Custom or its ID isn't in the built-in set. Once fixed there, sanity-check every other built-in (Copywriting / Content, Creative / Design, Email Marketing, Finance / Billing, Hosting / IT, and the rest of the 25 active list) to make sure none have the same gap.



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After creating the new template, the click handler needs to do two more things:

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- **Focus the name field in the header with the default text selected** so the user can start typing a real name immediately. Use *autoFocus* + *select()* on the input ref, same pattern the inline-rename uses on the Client hero.